TFSA + Margin Linked Multi-Brokerage Tracker: User Guide

Every tab, every column and every menu item, in plain English

The tracker is built around one idea: you type each transaction once, in the Transaction Log, and every other tab updates by itself. The only other place you type is the amber cells on Settings & Goals. Everything green is a formula: leave it alone and it will always be right. Your TFSAs and your taxable Margin and Cash accounts live side by side, at up to 8 brokerages, and the tracker links them: it knows how much borrowing power your TFSA gives you, keeps TFSA income out of your taxes, and catches a loss you sell in one account and buy back in the other.

Colour	Meaning
Amber	Your input. Type here (Settings & Goals).
Blue cell	A dropdown. Pick from the list (Institution, Account, Type, Currency).
White	Manual entry in the Transaction Log (date, ticker, shares, price, amount).
Green	A formula. Do not type here.
Blue / Red / Green / Slate	TFSA / Margin and Cash / TFSA collateral / both accounts together, on every tab.

Your template link: https://docs.google.com/spreadsheets/d/1S3XaECbb-eQfAd2DZZNrBKuhD1X0sJ6oJ992vb4mhwI/copy (opens Make a copy).

THE MAPLESHEET MENU

Menu item	What it does
Build / Rebuild All Tabs	Builds all 11 tabs. Safe to run again: it keeps your Settings inputs and Transaction Log rows.
Sort Transaction Log by Date	Puts every row in date order. The running ACB follows the row order, so use it if you logged something late.
Load Sample Data	Fills the Transaction Log with a sample investor: a TFSA and a margin account at Wealthsimple (TFSA pledged at 70%), the same at Questrade, and a cash account at RBC. Prices come from today's market. Replaces anything in the log.
Clear Sample Data	Empties the Transaction Log. Formulas, dropdowns and Settings stay.
Rebuild Dashboard Charts	Redraws the charts if one goes blank.
About	Shows the version.

First time you use the menu. Google shows an "Authorization required" box. Click Continue, choose your Google account, then Advanced and Allow. The script only works inside your own copy of the sheet.

1. SETTINGS & GOALS: SET UP ONCE, UPDATE EACH JANUARY

Cell	What to enter	Notes
B5 to B7	Your name, province and Active Year.	Change B7 every January.
B8	Your approximate marginal tax rate.	Only used for the after-tax cost of margin interest.
B9	The loan-to-value that should warn you (50% is cautious).	Loan ÷ value of your margin holdings.
B13 to B20	Up to 8 brokerages where you have a TFSA, Margin or Cash account.	Use exactly the same name every time.
C13 to C20	Each brokerage's yearly margin rate.	Blank for a cash-only brokerage.
D13 to D20	Each brokerage's TFSA collateral rate, ONLY if it lets you pledge your TFSA for your margin loan.	Ask your brokerage. Leave blank if it does not.
B23	The TFSA annual limit for the Active Year ($7,000 for 2026).	Update every January.
B24	Your TFSA room on January 1, from CRA My Account.	One number for ALL your TFSAs.
B45 to B47	Your income goal, portfolio value goal and income yield target.	Your own plan.
B50 to B51	Default currency and an optional USD/CAD rate.	Leave B51 blank to use the live rate.

The grey cells are a quick reference (TFSA over-contribution tax, withdrawals, the collateral rule, capital gains, dividends, the superficial loss window and Line 22100). At the bottom are two checklists, one for December and one for January.

2. TRANSACTION LOG: THE ONLY TAB YOU TYPE INTO

One row per transaction, starting on row 4, in date order. Never delete old rows: your ACB, TFSA room and margin loan depend on the full history. **Already own investments?** Log each holding once as a Buy dated the day you start, with column L = what it cost you. Log this year's TFSA deposits and withdrawals with their real dates.

Col	Column	What to enter
A	Date	The trade or deposit date (yyyy-mm-dd).
B	Year	Automatic.
C	Institution	Dropdown from Settings B13:B20.
D	Account	**TFSA, Margin or Cash. Pick it on every row.** It decides which portfolio and which cost pool the row counts in, and whether it is taxable.
E	Type	Dropdown, see the table below.
F	Ticker	With the exchange prefix: TSE:XEQT, TSE:RY, NASDAQ:AAPL, NYSE:JPM. Blank for deposits and interest.
G	Description	Anything that helps you remember.
H	Currency	CAD or USD.
I to K	Shares, Price, Commission	For Buy, Sell and DRIP.
L	Amt (Original)	The total in the original currency. Leave blank on a Buy or Sell and it is calculated.
M, N	FX Rate, Amt (CAD)	Automatic. Every dashboard adds up column N.
O	Realized Gain / Loss	Automatic on every Sell, using the average cost of THAT pool (TFSA, or all your taxable accounts together).

Col	Column	What to enter
P	Check	Automatic. Flags a possible superficial loss (including one bought back in your TFSA), selling more than you hold, a missing account or ticker, rows out of date order, or margin interest on a non-margin account.

Type	Use it for
Deposit / Withdrawal	Cash in or out. In a TFSA, a Deposit is a contribution and uses room; a Withdrawal comes back as room next January 1. Out of a Margin account, a Withdrawal adds to your loan.
Buy / Sell	Shares, price and commission.
Dividend / DRIP	Cash dividend, or a dividend reinvested in new shares. Log US dividends at the GROSS amount.
Interest Income	Interest your brokerage pays on cash.
Margin Interest	The monthly interest charged on your margin loan. Account = Margin. Feeds Line 22100.
Fee	Account or admin fees.
Return of Capital / Reinvested Distribution	ETF adjustments to your ACB, from the T3 slip.
Transfer Out / Transfer In	Shares moved between two of YOUR accounts of the same kind (TFSA to TFSA, or taxable to taxable) at different brokerages. Not a sale. Moving shares from a taxable account INTO a TFSA is a sale: log a Sell, then a TFSA Deposit and a Buy.

3. MAIN DASHBOARD

Section	What it shows
Brokerage cards	One column per brokerage plus All Brokerages: TFSA value, Margin and Cash value, total, margin loan, net worth, the extra borrowing power from your TFSA, income and margin interest this year.
Leverage, TFSA collateral & break-even	Your loan, margin holdings, loan-to-value against your warning level, TFSA borrowing power, interest paid, a full year of interest at today's loan, break-even yield, income yield and after-tax cost, with a message line.
TFSA room	Annual limit, room on January 1, deposits this year at every brokerage, room left, withdrawals and the room you get back next January 1. Turns red if you are over.
Tax snapshot	Net capital gain, taxable gain, dividends, foreign income, Line 22100 interest and rows to check, from the Margin and Cash accounts only.
Right column	Last 5 transactions, goals with progress bars, and a chart of TFSA vs Margin & Cash vs Combined.
Charts	TFSA, Margin & Cash and the loan by brokerage, and margin interest vs income by month.

4. TFSA PORTFOLIO AND MARGIN PORTFOLIO

Both tabs are automatic. Each ticker appears once per tab, with the shares held at every brokerage combined, the average cost, live price in CAD, market value, gain or loss, return, realized gain this year and income this year. **The two pools never mix:** if you own ENB in your TFSA and in your margin account, each tab has its own ENB line with its own average cost. On the Margin Portfolio, that average cost is your pooled ACB across every taxable account at every brokerage, which is what the CRA uses. TFSA numbers never go on your return.

5. INSTITUTION DASHBOARD

Every brokerage side by side: TFSA value and cost, Margin and Cash value and ACB, unrealized gain, cash balance (negative = margin loan), TFSA cash, margin rate, collateral rate, extra borrowing power, margin interest, income, TFSA deposits this year, sell proceeds (to compare with box 21 of each T5008) and realized gain. On the right, a donut chart and a table show the share of your money at each brokerage.

6. MARGIN & COLLATERAL

Part	What it shows
KPI cards	Interest paid this year, loan now, average rate, a full year of interest, margin holdings value, break-even yield, income yield and the extra borrowing power from your TFSA.
Section A	Per brokerage: rate, loan, monthly interest, interest paid, margin holdings, loan-to-value, TFSA value, collateral rate, borrowing power from the TFSA and a status. Below it, one line tells you how much of that borrowing power your loan uses.
Section B	Each month: interest paid vs income from your margin accounts, with a chart.

How the link is calculated. TFSA value at a brokerage × the collateral rate you entered for that brokerage = the extra borrowing power. Example: $7,500 in your Wealthsimple TFSA × 70% = $5,250. If your margin loan there is $4,600, it uses 88% of that power. Pledging your TFSA does not touch your contribution room, but in a margin call your brokerage can sell TFSA holdings.

7. DIVIDEND TRACKER

Cards for income all time, TFSA this year (tax-free), Margin and Cash this year (taxable), DRIP, the monthly average, a full-year estimate and your goal. A note shows the US withholding lost in your TFSA and the part you can recover in your taxable accounts. Section A splits each month into TFSA and Margin & Cash; Section B lists every dividend; Section C totals each ticker by account.

8. TAX SUMMARY

Line	Amount
Line 12000 / 40425	Eligible dividends × 1.38, and the federal dividend tax credit.
Line 12100 / 40500	Foreign dividends and interest, and the 15% US tax as a foreign tax credit.
Line 12700	50% of your net capital gain, using your pooled ACB.
Line 22100	Margin interest.
If denied	Your gain if the flagged superficial losses are denied.
Not taxable	TFSA income and gains this year, shown so you can see them, never reported.

Section B checks each brokerage's sell proceeds against its T5008; Section C lists every taxable sale for Schedule 3.

9. TFSA & MARGIN RULES

Colour-coded cards: red = costly mistake, amber = limit or deadline, green = benefit. Sections: your TFSA, the TFSA + margin link, capital gains, margin interest and risk, dividends and slips. The Government Rules PDF explains each one with examples.

COMMON QUESTIONS

Question	Answer
Where do I type my margin loan?	Nowhere. It is the negative cash balance of your Margin account at each brokerage, from your deposits, buys, sells, dividends and interest.
My brokerage does not accept my TFSA as collateral.	Leave its collateral rate blank. Everything else still works.
Column P says "bought back in your TFSA".	You sold at a loss in a taxable account and bought the same shares in your TFSA within 30 days. The CRA denies that loss, and it cannot be recovered.
A chart is blank.	Menu: Rebuild Dashboard Charts.
New year?	Make a copy, change B7, update B23 and B24 from CRA My Account, and keep logging below your old rows.

For educational purposes only. Not financial or tax advice. Rules summarized for 2026 from canada.ca. Always confirm your own TFSA room in CRA My Account. Questions: hello@maplesheet.ca